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Apple projects tariff costs will hit \$1.1B next quarter

Dominic-Madori Davis — 4:25 PM PDT · July 31, 2025

Tariffs are projected to cost Apple \$1.1 billion in the July-to-September quarter, an uptick from the previous period, CEO Tim Cook said during the company's earnings call with investors Thursday.

Those cost projections, which are based on current rates and policies, could end up lower than expected as they did in the previous quarter. Apple incurred about \$800 million of tariff-related costs for the June quarter, less than the \$900 million estimate the company shared in May.

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Cook said most of the tariffs levied against Apple stem from the International Emergency Economic Powers Act (IEEPA). Earlier this year, and amid a brewing trade war, the U.S. government and China agreed to a 30% tariff [on imports from China](#). That trade agreement, which reduced “reciprocal” tariffs from 125% to 10% ([plus the 20% duty](#) against China related to fentanyl), stands until August 12.

While sales growth suggests fear of tariffs helped fuel sales, Cook downplayed the “pull forward” effect, noting that consumers were more motivated by the “strength of the product.”

“If you look at iPhone, the 16 family grew double digits, as opposed to the 15 family from the year-ago quarter,” Cook said on the call. “And so we did set an upgrade record ... I think it directly is because of the strength of the product.”

Sales of the iPhone rose 13% year-over-year and generated [\\$44.5 billion in revenue](#) — nearly half of the entire company’s total revenue this quarter, which reached \$94 billion.

Still, tariffs have had an impact and may continue to do so, even if Apple shifts its manufacturing strategy to countries with lower tariffs.

Apple devices are mainly manufactured in India, China, and Vietnam. Nearly half the iPhones sold in the U.S. are produced in India, while Macs, iPads, and watches bound for U.S. customers are made in Vietnam. Both India and Vietnam are subjected to tariffs of 25% and 20%, respectively.

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President Trump previously expressed his dismay at Apple shifting its supply chain focus more toward India, threatening the company with a 25% tariff unless Apple moved iPhone production to the U.S.

Cook reiterated Apple’s commitment to the U.S. in Thursday’s investors call, saying the company has committed [\\$500 billion in investments](#) to the U.S. over the next four years, building chips and semiconductors across the country.

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Dominic-Madori Davis is a senior venture capital and startup reporter at TechCrunch. She is based in New York City....

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Rocket Lab eyes big defense opportunities with new acquisition

Aria Alamalhodaei — 2:23 PM PDT · August 7, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS: ROCKET LAB
Rocket Lab is signaling to investors, yet again, that it's more than "just" a rocket company.

Rocket Lab's second-quarter results, which were posted Thursday, show revenues continue to be driven by its space systems business rather than launch. The results also highlighted the company's acquisition strategy and how its purchase of a new optical payloads company will make it more competitive for lucrative government contracts.

The company's space systems brought in \$97.9 million of the \$144.5 million in total revenues for the second quarter. Rocket Labs' total revenue, its highest quarterly revenue in the company's history, jumped 36% from a year ago. The company's net loss widened to \$66.4 million.

Rocket Lab founder and CEO Peter Beck highlighted the "busy quarter of M&A activity" as the company gets close to closing its deal to buy [Geost](#), a company that builds optical payloads. Through that acquisition, which will close at \$275 million in cash and equity, Rocket Lab is opening a new business unit called Optical Systems to scale electro-optical and infrared sensor manufacturing.

Those sensors are used in missile warning, tracking, and space domain awareness. The acquisition is also one part of a larger play from Rocket Lab — spelled out quite explicitly in the company's earnings presentation — to bid for multibillion-dollar [DOD initiatives like Golden](#)

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The company is staying vague about the exact launch date, saying only in the presentation that it is pushing an “all-out effort to get Neutron to the launch pad before the end of 2025.”

Rocket Lab ended the quarter with \$564 million in cash and cash equivalents and estimates revenues will hit between \$145 to \$155 million next quarter.

Topics: [earnings](#) [Mergers and Acquisitions](#) [Rocket Lab](#) [Space](#)



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Aria Alamalhodaei

Reporter, Space and Defense | [X](#)

Aria Alamalhodaei covers the space and defense industries at TechCrunch. Previously, she covered the public utilities and the power grid for California Energy...

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Citizen Lab director warns cyber industry about US authoritarian descent

Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai — 8:01 AM PDT · August 6, 2025



Ron Deibert, the director of Citizen Lab, one of the most prominent organizations investigating government spyware abuses, is sounding the alarm to the cybersecurity community and asking them to step up and join the fight against authoritarianism.

On Wednesday, Deibert [will deliver a keynote](#) at the Black Hat cybersecurity conference in Las Vegas, one of the largest gatherings of information security professionals of the year.

Ahead of his talk, Deibert told TechCrunch that he plans to speak about what he describes as a “descent into a kind of fusion of tech and fascism,” and the role that the Big Tech platforms are playing, and “propelling forward a really frightening type of collective insecurity that isn’t typically addressed by this crowd, this community, as a cybersecurity problem.”

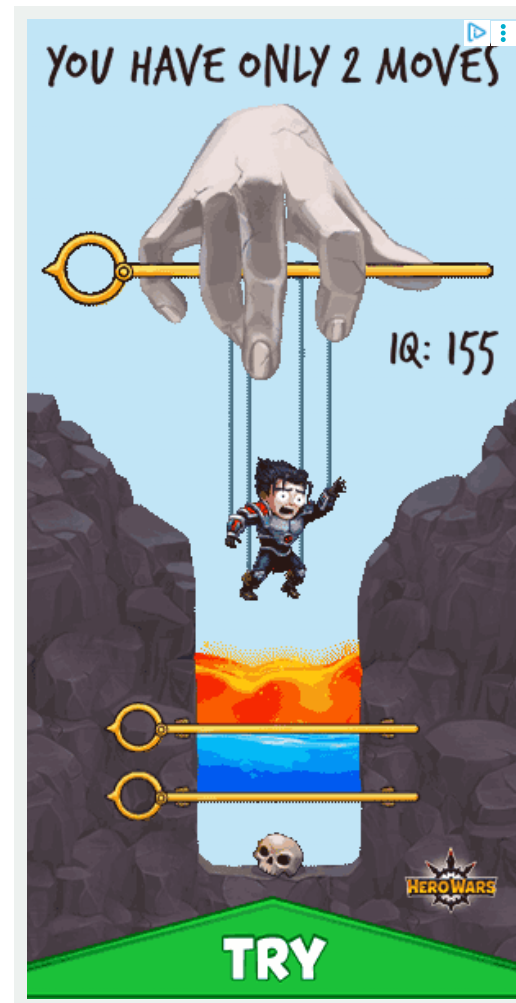
Deibert described the recent political events in the United States as a “dramatic descent into authoritarianism,” but one that the cybersecurity community can help defend against.

“I think alarm bells need to be rung for this community that, at the very least, they should be aware of what’s going on and hopefully they can not contribute to it, if not help reverse it,” Deibert told TechCrunch.

Historically, at least in the United States, the cybersecurity industry has put politics — to a certain extent — to the side. More recently, however, politics has fully entered the world of cybersecurity.

Earlier this year, President Donald Trump [ordered an investigation into former CISA director Chris Krebs](#), who had publicly rebuffed Trump’s false claims about election fraud by declaring the 2020 election secure. Trump later [fired Krebs by tweet](#). The investigation ordered by Trump months after his 2024 reelection forced Krebs to [step down from SentinelOne and vow to fight back](#).

In response, Jen Easterly, another former CISA director and Krebs’ successor, [called on the cybersecurity community to get involved](#) and



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speak out.

“If we stay silent when experienced, mission-driven leaders are sidelined or sanctioned, we risk something greater than discomfort; we risk diminishing the very institutions we are here to protect,” Easterly wrote in a post on LinkedIn.

Easterly was herself [a victim of political pressure](#) from the Trump administration when her offer to join West Point was rescinded in late July.

Deibert, who this year [published his new book](#), “Chasing Shadows: Cyber Espionage, Subversion, and the Global Fight for Democracy,” is echoing the same message as Easterly.

“I think that there comes a point at which you have to recognize that the landscape is changing around you, and the security problems you set out for yourselves are maybe trivial in light of the broader context and the insecurities that are being propelled forward in the absence of proper checks and balances and oversight, which are deteriorating,” said Deibert.

Deibert is also concerned that big companies like Meta, Google, and Apple could take a step back in their efforts to fight against government spyware — [sometimes referred](#) to as “commercial” or “mercenary” spyware — by gutting their threat intelligence teams.

These threat intelligence teams are dedicated groups of security researchers that track government hackers, both those working inside government agencies, such as China’s Ministry of State Security or Russia’s intelligence agencies FSB and GRU, and companies such as NSO Group or Paragon.

These are the same teams that are responsible for detecting hacks against their own users, such as when [WhatsApp caught NSO Group](#) hacking more than 1,400 of its users in 2019, or when Apple caught hackers using government spyware to target its customers and [notified the victims](#) of the [attacks](#).

Deibert believes there is a “huge market failure when it comes to cybersecurity for global civil society,” a part of the population that generally cannot afford to get help from big security companies that typically serve governments and corporate clients. “This market failure is going to get more acute as supporting institutions evaporate and attacks on civil society amplify,” he said.

“Whatever they can do to contribute to offset this market failure (e.g., pro bono work) will be essential to the future of liberal democracy worldwide,” he said.

Deibert is concerned that these threat intelligence teams could be cut or at least reduced, given that the same companies have cut their

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moderation and safety teams.

He told TechCrunch that threat intelligence teams, like the ones at Meta, are doing “amazing work,” in part by staying siloed and separate from the commercial arms of their wider organizations.

“But the question is how long will that last?” said Deibert.

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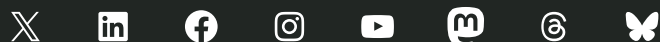
Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai

Senior Reporter, Cybersecurity | [X](#) [B](#) [M](#)

Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai is a Senior Writer at TechCrunch, where he covers hacking, cybersecurity, surveillance, and privacy....

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